# 📖 SSC CGL — English Grammar Rules Tables

**Active ↔ Passive · Direct ↔ Indirect · Error Spotting** — rule → formula → example, with authentic PYQ-pattern questions (2021–2025).

Target post: ASO · Tier-I English · every example drawn from the repo's Voice/Narration & Error-Detection banks.

🟢 Correct form 🔴 Wrong form (trap) 🔴 High-repeat rule PYQ = actual repo question

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**How to use:** Each table is **Rule → Formula → Example (Active/Direct → Passive/Indirect)**. The PYQ boxes are the exact questions from the repository's solved banks so you can see the rule tested the way SSC actually asks it.

## 1 · Active → Passive Voice — the 8 tenses 🔴 High Repeat

Core formula: `Object + correct form of BE + past participle (V₃) + by + agent`. Keep the **tense unchanged**; only the *be*-form changes.

| TENSE | PASSIVE "BE" FORM | ACTIVE EXAMPLE | PASSIVE EXAMPLE | PYQ |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Simple Present | `is / am / are + V₃` | Every morning the senior editor, along with two junior assistants, reviews the manuscripts that authors submit from across the country. | Every morning the manuscripts that authors submit from across the country **are reviewed** by the senior editor along with two junior assistants. | PY let he wi te th "e |
| Present Continuous | `is / am / are being + V₃` | While the auditors examine last year's records, the finance team is preparing the revised budget that the board of directors requested in the previous meeting. | While last year's records are being examined by the auditors, the revised budget that the board of directors requested in the previous meeting **is being prepared** by the finance team. | PY pr be No in co |
| Present Perfect | `has / have been + V₃` | The government, together with several international agencies, has recently launched three welfare schemes that millions of | Three welfare schemes that millions of families in rural districts have been waiting for **have recently been launched** by the government together with | PY st ha pl |

| TENSE | PASSIVE "BE" FORM | ACTIVE EXAMPLE | PASSIVE EXAMPLE | PYQ |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| | | families in rural districts have been waiting for. | several international agencies. | nc "re |
| Simple Past | `was / were + V₃` | After the results were declared, the principal, in the presence of the parents and the visiting inspectors, awarded gold medals to the three students who had topped the examination. | After the results were declared, gold medals **were awarded** to the three students who had topped the examination by the principal, in the presence of the parents and the visiting inspectors. | PY pr st te "m to ur |
| Past Continuous | `was / were being + V₃` | When the earthquake struck at midnight, the workers were still repairing the old bridge that connected the two villages separated by the river. | When the earthquake struck at midnight, the old bridge that connected the two villages separated by the river **was still being repaired** by the workers. | PY re by re Tr ea or pa |
| Simple Future | `will be + V₃` | Once the verification is complete, the selection committee will announce the final list of candidates who have qualified for the interview round next week. | Once the verification is complete, the final list of candidates who have qualified for the interview round **will be announced** next week by the selection committee. | PY wi wi co ve su it i |
| Modal (should/can/must) | `modal + be + V₃` | One should keep one's promises. | Promises should be kept. | PY pr be |
| Generic agent | `is/are + V₃` (drop agent) | People speak English all over the world. | English is spoken all over the world. | PY En wo or |

## 2 · Passive Voice — traps & reverse (Passive → Active)

| SITUATION | RULE | CORRECT | |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Passive → Active** | Match the tense back; passive "is being + $V_3$" ⇒ active "is + V-ing". | "A new bridge is being built by the government." → The government is building a new bridge. | |
| **Perfect tenses only take "been"** | has/have/had + **been** + $V_3$ — never "has + $V_3$". | has been completed | |
| **No progressive in perfect passive** | Present perfect passive is "has been + $V_3$", not "-ing". | My bicycle has been stolen. | |
| **Keep agent only if meaningful** | Drop by-agent when it is people / one / someone / they (general). | English is spoken all over the world. | |

## 2b · Passive Voice — advanced & harder tenses 🔴 Mock-test level

These are the tenses that separate 20/25 from full marks. Note the two **"only" rules**: perfect tenses insert **been**; future/modal insert **be**. Continuous perfects and infinitives usually stay active in the exam.

| TENSE | PASSIVE "BE" FORM | ACTIVE EXAMPLE | PASSIVE EXAMPLE | REVE |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Past Perfect** | `had been + V₃` | She had written the report. | The report had been written by her. | had b |
| **Future Continuous** | `will be + V-ing → (rare; kept active)` | They will be painting the wall. | The wall will be being painted. (usually avoided) | Exam trap. |
| **Future Perfect** screenshot | `will have been + V₃ + time clause` | They will have translated the manuscript by the time the committee submits its report. | The manuscript will have been translated by the time the committee submits its final report. | **will h** **will h** claus |
| **Modal Perfect** | `modal + have been + V₃` | He must have finished the task. | The task must have been finished by him. | must + $V_3$ |
| **Infinitive** | `to be + V₃` | I have a letter to write. | I have a letter to be written. | to be |
| **Imperative** | `Let + object + be + V₃` | Close the door. | Let the door be closed. | Let ... objec |

**Future Perfect worked example (from an SSC CGL mock, T-I English):**
Passive given: "*...will have been translated by the time the review committee submits its final report.*"
Correct active: **"They will have translated the manuscript by the time the review committee submits its final report."**
**Why the traps fail:** ~~will translate~~ = simple future (wrong tense) · ~~have translated~~ = present perfect (wrong tense) · any option that reorders the "by the time..." clause changes the meaning.
**Rule:** Future-perfect passive `will have been + V₃` ⇄ active `will have + V₃` — the "will have" is the anchor; never drop to "will" or "have".

## 3 · Direct → Indirect Speech — the change-rules 🔴 High Repeat

Three things always change when the reporting verb is **past**: (1) tense back-shifts, (2) pronouns adjust to the reporter, (3) time/place words shift.

### 3a · Tense back-shift

| DIRECT TENSE | → | INDIRECT TENSE | EXAMPLE (FROM REPO) |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Simple Present** | → | Simple Past | "I am tired." → He said that he **was** tired. |
| **Present Continuous** | → | Past Continuous | "Are you coming?" → asked if she **was comin** |
| **Present Perfect** | → | Past Perfect | "I have finished now." → she **had finished** ...th |
| **Simple Past** | → | Past Perfect | "Where do you live?" → asked where I **lived**. |
| **will** | → | would | "I will help you." → said she **would** help me. |
| **may** | → | might | "May God bless you!" → prayed God **might** bl |

### 3b · Time / place / pronoun shifts

| DIRECT | → | INDIRECT | DIRECT | → | INDIRECT |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| now | → | **then** | this | → | **that** |
| today | → | **that day** | here | → | **there** |
| tomorrow | → | **the next day** | ago | → | **before** |
| yesterday | → | **the previous day** | these | → | **those** |
| I / we | → | **he / she / they** | you | → | **me / him (p** |

## 4 · Narration by sentence type — reporting verb & connector

The reporting verb changes with the sentence's purpose. This is the most-tested distinction in the PYQ bank.

| SENTENCE TYPE | REPORTING VERB | CONNECTOR / PATTERN | DIRECT → INDIRECT EXAMPLE (REPO |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Statement** | said / told | `that + clause` | "I am tired." → He said that he was tired |
| **Wh-question** | asked | `asked + wh-word + statement order` (drop do/did) | "Where were you and your brother going the car last night?" → The inspector asked **and I had been going** when the police night. short: "Where do you live?" → asked |
| **Yes/No question** | asked | `asked + if / whether + clause` | "Have you and your colleagues finished yesterday?" → The manager asked us w **colleagues had finished** the report tha previous day. short: "Are you coming?" → |
| **Command (order)** | ordered | `ordered + obj + to + V₁` | "Submit all the pending files to my offic today." → The director ordered the cler **files to his office before they left for** short: "March forward." → ordered … to marc |
| **Request (polite)** | requested | `requested + obj + to + V₁` ("please" → requested) | "Please close the window." → She reque |
| **Negative command** | ordered / forbade | `+ not + to + V₁` | "Do not make noise." → The teacher or |
| **Exclamation** | exclaimed | `exclaimed that + … very …` | "What a beautiful sight it is!" → He excl beautiful sight. |
| **Wish / prayer (optative)** | prayed / wished | `prayed that + might` | "May God bless you!" → He prayed tha |

## 5 · Error Spotting — high-yield rules 🔴 High Repeat

**The "more subjects = more chaos" strategy:** SSC lengthens the sentence and stuffs 3–4 nouns between the real subject and the verb so your ear agrees the verb with the *nearest* noun instead of the *true* one. **Fix:** mentally delete everything between commas / inside "who/which" clauses, strip it down to **subject + verb**, then check agreement. The verb answers to the head-noun only.

Check in this order: **subject–verb agreement → tense → preposition → article → pronoun/comparative**. Read the whole sentence — "No error" is sometimes correct. **The long sentences below are where SSC hides the trap:** the more nouns crammed between the subject and its verb, the easier it is to agree the verb with the wrong one.

| RULE | WHAT TO WATCH | WRONG ✗ | CORRECT ✓ | LONG EXAM-GRADE SENTE |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **"One of..." is singular** | Subject is "One", not the plural noun after it. | ~~One of my friends are going~~ | One of my friends is going | "One of the many candidates post **were** found ineligible d verification." → subject is **On** short PYQ: "One of my friends |
| **"along with / with" phrase** | Phrase between commas doesn't change the number. | The boy ... ~~were playing~~ | The boy ... was playing | "The captain of the team, alo reserve players, **were** confide season." → subject is **captair** short PYQ: "The boy along wit was |
| **Each / Every / Neither = singular** | Take a singular verb & singular pronoun. | ~~Each of the students have~~ | Each of the students has | "Each of the officers, manage attended the annual confere submit their feedback." → **Ea asked**. short PYQ: "Each of the stude |
| **"The number of" = singular** | vs "A number of" = plural. | The number of applicants ~~have increased~~ | The number of applicants has increased | "The number of students app examinations across the nort over the last decade." → "The **risen**. short PYQ: "The number of st |
| **since vs for** | since = point in time; for = period. | working here ~~since five years~~ | working here for five years | "My uncle, who retired from farm near the hills, has been **twelve years**." → period → **f** short PYQ: "working here sinc |
| **Double comparative** | Never "more + -er". | He is ~~more taller~~ than his brother | He is taller than his brother | "Although he had trained for proved to be **more stronger** his seasoned rivals." → **stron** short PYQ: "more taller than h |

| RULE | WHAT TO WATCH | WRONG ✗ | CORRECT ✓ | LONG EXAM-GRADE SENTE |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Uncountable nouns** | advice/information/furniture — no "a/an", no -s. | He gave me ~~an advice~~ | He gave me **a piece of advice** | "The professor, before he left students **many useful advic** informations about the upco **useful advice** and **important** short PYQ: "an advice" → a pie |
| **Collective noun (act individually)** | jury/committee take plural verb when divided. | The jury ~~was divided~~ in their opinion | The jury **were divided** in their opinion | "The committee, which had r discuss the disputed proposa themselves over the final dec **were divided**. short PYQ: "The jury was divid |
| **"one of those … who"** | Verb agrees with plural noun, not "one". | one of those students who ~~always works~~ | one of those students who **always work** | "He is one of those rare lead admit a mistake and always l members of the team." → "w **hesitate**. short PYQ: "one of those stud |

## 6 · Correlative pairs & preposition partners

Memorise these — they are pure recall marks in every SSC paper.

### 6a · Correlative pairs (fixed connectors)

| CORRECT PAIR | WRONG (TRAP) | EXAMPLE / PYQ |
|---|---|---|
| **No sooner … than** | No sooner … ~~when~~ | "No sooner did the bell ring **than** the children rushe |
| **Hardly / Scarcely … when** | Hardly … ~~than~~ | "Scarcely had I reached … **when** the train left." (PYQ |
| **Neither … nor** | Neither … ~~or~~ | Verb agrees with the **nearer** subject. |
| **Either … or** | Either … ~~nor~~ | Either the boy or his friends **are** … |
| **Not only … but also** | Not only … ~~but~~ | — |

### 6b · Preposition partners (fixed)

| CORRECT | WRONG (TRAP) | PYQ (REPO) |
|---|---|---|
| **senior** to | senior ~~than~~ | "She is senior **than me**" → senior to me (PYQ) |
| **prefer** ... to | prefer ... ~~than~~ | "She prefers reading **than** watching TV" → to watching (P |
| **good** at | good ~~in~~ | "Both sisters are good **in** mathematics" → good at (PYQ) |
| **married** to | married ~~with~~ | She is married to him. |
| **superior** to | superior ~~than~~ | This model is superior to that one. |

## ★ Quick Recall — the night-before checklist

| TOPIC | THE ONE THING TO REMEMBER |
|---|---|
| **Passive voice** | Object + **correct BE** + $V_3$ + by agent; match BE to the **original tense**; perfect always uses ' |
| **Passive → Active** | Reverse the BE-form back to the same tense (is being → is + V-ing). |
| **Indirect speech** | Past reporting verb ⇒ **back-shift tense, change pronouns, shift now→then / here→ther** |
| **Narration verb** | asked (question), ordered/requested (command), exclaimed (!), prayed (wish). |
| **Error — agreement** | Find the **real subject**; ignore phrases between commas; "One of / Each / The number of / N |
| **Error — prepositions** | senior/prefer/superior/junior **to**; good **at**; married **to**. |
| **Error — pairs** | No sooner...**than**; Hardly/Scarcely...**when**; Neither...**nor**. |
| **Error — misc** | No double comparative (more taller ✗); uncountables take no "a/an" (an advice ✗); "since" |

**Exam reflex:** In voice, first name the **tense** — the passive writes itself. In narration, first name the **sentence type** — it fixes the reporting verb. In error spotting, first find the **true subject** — most errors are agreement.